



NODUS · COMPLETE VAULT GUIDE

# Teaching

Plan courses and assess transparently without outsourcing judgement.

---

The Teaching vault connects courses, groups, materials and schedules to reusable questions, rubrics, exams and defensible gradebooks. AI may help create teaching content but never evaluates students.

|          |                                              |
|----------|----------------------------------------------|
| EDITION  | English                                      |
| VERSION  | Nodus 4.1                                    |
| UPDATED  | 14 August 2026                               |
| AUDIENCE | Teachers, lecturers and course coordinators. |

# Contents

Core operation, configuration and the complete vault workflow.

|                                    |           |
|------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Core Nodus workflow</b>         | <b>3</b>  |
| 1 Welcome to Nodus                 | 3         |
| 2 Create and switch vaults         | 4         |
| 3 Navigation and global search     | 5         |
| 4 Library, sources and reader      | 5         |
| 5 AI providers and task models     | 6         |
| 6 Privacy, backups and recovery    | 7         |
| 7 Toolkit and integrations         | 7         |
| <b>Complete Teaching workflow</b>  | <b>9</b>  |
| 1 Home and academic-year overview  | 9         |
| 2 Courses and subjects             | 10        |
| 3 Groups and private rosters       | 11        |
| 4 Timetable                        | 11        |
| 5 Calendar                         | 12        |
| 6 Teaching materials               | 13        |
| 7 Recordings                       | 14        |
| 8 Question bank                    | 14        |
| 9 Rubrics                          | 15        |
| 10 Exam builder and print export   | 15        |
| 11 Gradebooks and assessment plans | 16        |
| 12 Teaching plans and units        | 17        |
| 13 Privacy and responsible AI      | 18        |
| <b>Completion checklist</b>        | <b>19</b> |

## PART I · FOUNDATION

# Core Nodus workflow

These operating principles apply to every vault. They establish the local-first data boundary, source workflow, optional model configuration and recovery discipline used throughout this manual.

## START HERE

## 1 Welcome to Nodus

Nodus is a local-first desktop workspace for research, teaching and study. Work is organised into focused vaults that share one private engine.

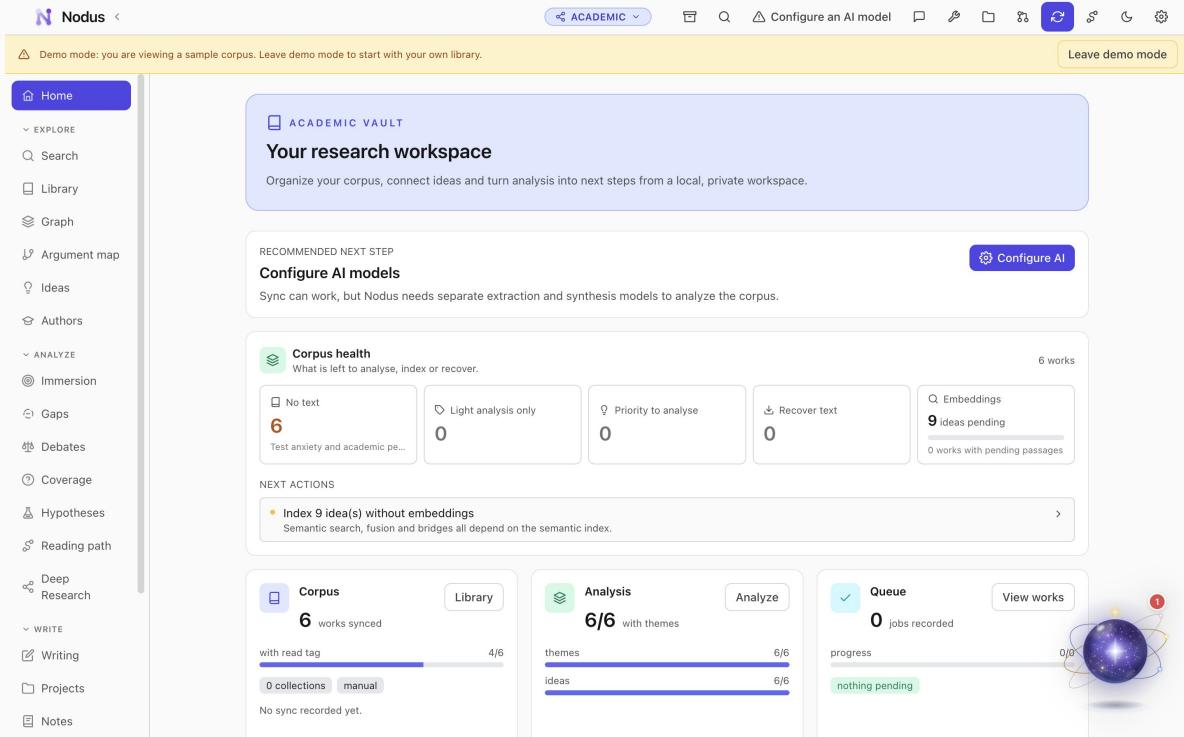
A vault changes the navigation, workflows and assistant context without changing the core promises: your database and indexes remain on your computer, accounts are optional, and AI runs only when a feature needs it and you have configured a provider.

## STEP BY STEP

1. Install the current package for macOS, Windows or Linux from the Nodus release page.
2. Open Nodus and choose the interface language, Nodi style and tutorial path.
3. Create a vault for the kind of work you are doing, or load its sample vault before importing your own material.

## GOOD PRACTICE

- Use one vault per coherent project, course, family or dataset.
- Sample vaults are disposable and are the safest way to explore.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## START HERE

# 2 Create and switch vaults

Create independent workspaces and move between them without mixing their context.

The vault switcher is the boundary between projects. Each vault has its own notes, analysis and domain records, while the global Library can link the same source into compatible vaults without duplicating it.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Open the vault switcher from the application header and choose New vault.
2. Name the vault, choose its type and review the short description before confirming.
3. Use the same switcher to move to another vault; Nodus restores the last open section.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Use explicit names such as 'MA thesis - memory' or 'Biology 2026'.
- Changing a vault type after substantial work is not a substitute for creating the correct vault.

## ESSENTIALS

## 3 Navigation and global search

The sidebar exposes the workflow for the active vault; search retrieves material across the relevant local index.

Sections are grouped by intent - explore, analyse and write, or organisation and assessment. Search combines exact keyword matching with semantic retrieval when an embedding model is configured, and results preserve links to their source.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Choose a section in the left sidebar; the active section is highlighted.
2. Open Search and enter at least two meaningful characters or a natural-language concept.
3. Filter or inspect a result, then follow its source link to the document, record, person or note.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Search for concepts, not only exact titles.
- Rebuild an index from Settings if recently imported content does not appear.

### ESSENTIALS

## 4 Library, sources and reader

Keep preserved originals beside clean reading copies, citations, highlights and extracted evidence.

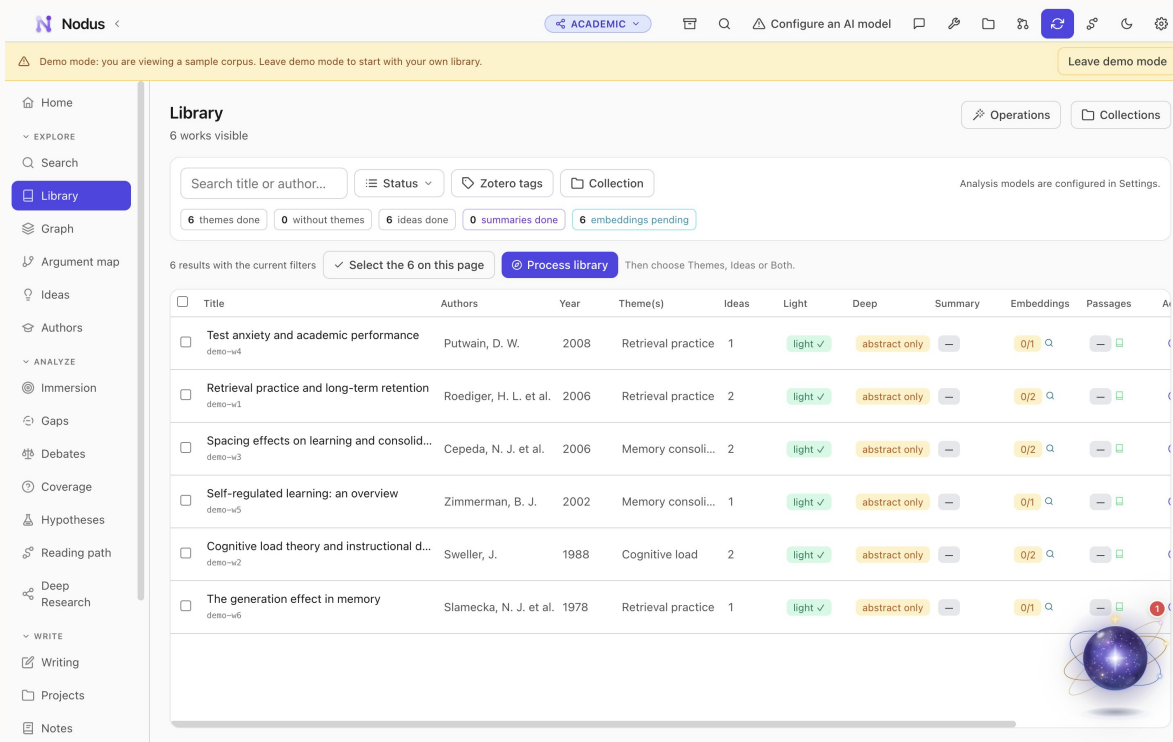
The cross-vault Library can mirror Zotero, import RIS, BibTeX and CSL JSON, or accept files directly. Nodus preserves the original attachment and creates searchable derivatives. Compatible sources can be linked to several vaults without copying the original.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Open Library and add a local file, import bibliographic data or connect Zotero.
2. Place the item in a collection and add useful tags; wait for extraction and indexing to finish.
3. Open the item, choose the clean reading copy or preserved original, then highlight passages and link the item into the active vault.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Keep the preserved original for page-accurate verification.
- Treat automatically extracted text and metadata as a first pass that may need correction.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## CONFIGURATION

# 5 AI providers and task models

Bring your own cloud key or use compatible local models, with a different model for each task.

Provider keys are stored in the operating-system keychain. Nodus distinguishes deterministic local tools from model-assisted features and shows when content will leave the device. Model preferences can mix providers by extraction, chat, writing and report tasks.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Open Settings, then Providers, and configure a cloud key or local endpoint.
2. Use the validation action before saving, then open Models.
3. Assign a suitable model to each task and run a small test on sample content.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- A local model improves privacy but may require more memory and time.
- Review every generated claim against its linked evidence.

## CONFIGURATION

## 6 Privacy, backups and recovery

Protect local work with a verified backup and understand exactly when network services are used.

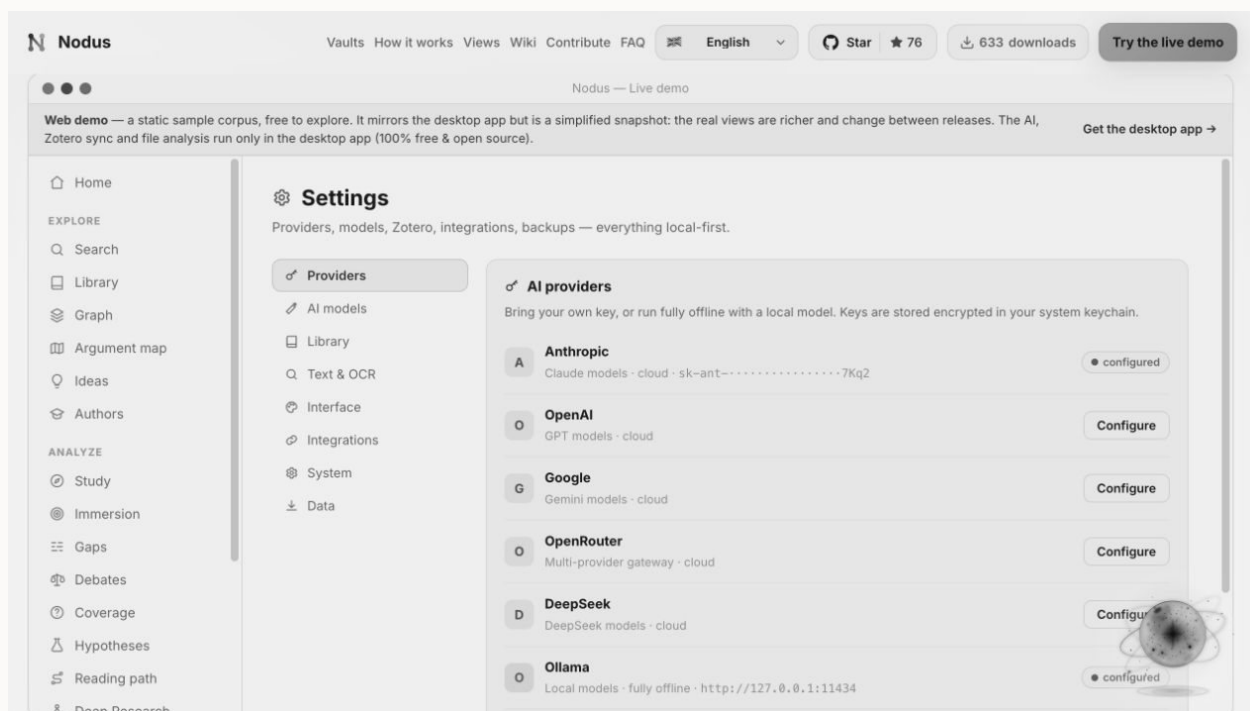
Vault databases, indexes and library files are local by default. Backups can include all vaults and the shared Library. Nodus reports backup health and creates protected recovery copies before major migrations.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Open Settings, choose a backup destination and enable automatic backups.
2. Run a manual backup, then use verification to confirm that its manifest and files are readable.
3. Review the privacy notice for each optional online feature before sending content.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Store backups on a different physical device or a trusted encrypted location.
- Do not treat sync as a backup; keep versioned recovery copies.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

### CONFIGURATION

## 7 Toolkit and integrations

Convert, protect, translate, OCR and present documents, or connect Zotero, Word, MCP clients and Nodus Server.

Toolkit utilities are available across vaults. Integrations remain optional: Zotero supplies bibliographic material, Word uses grounded Nodus context, MCP exposes approved local tools, and Nodus Server publishes a selected copy rather than the source vault.

**STEP BY STEP**

1. Open Toolkit and choose Convert, Protect, Translate, OCR Workspace or PDF Presenter.
2. Select a file from disk or a compatible vault source and review the output options.
3. For an integration, enable only the connector you need and test it with non-sensitive sample content first.

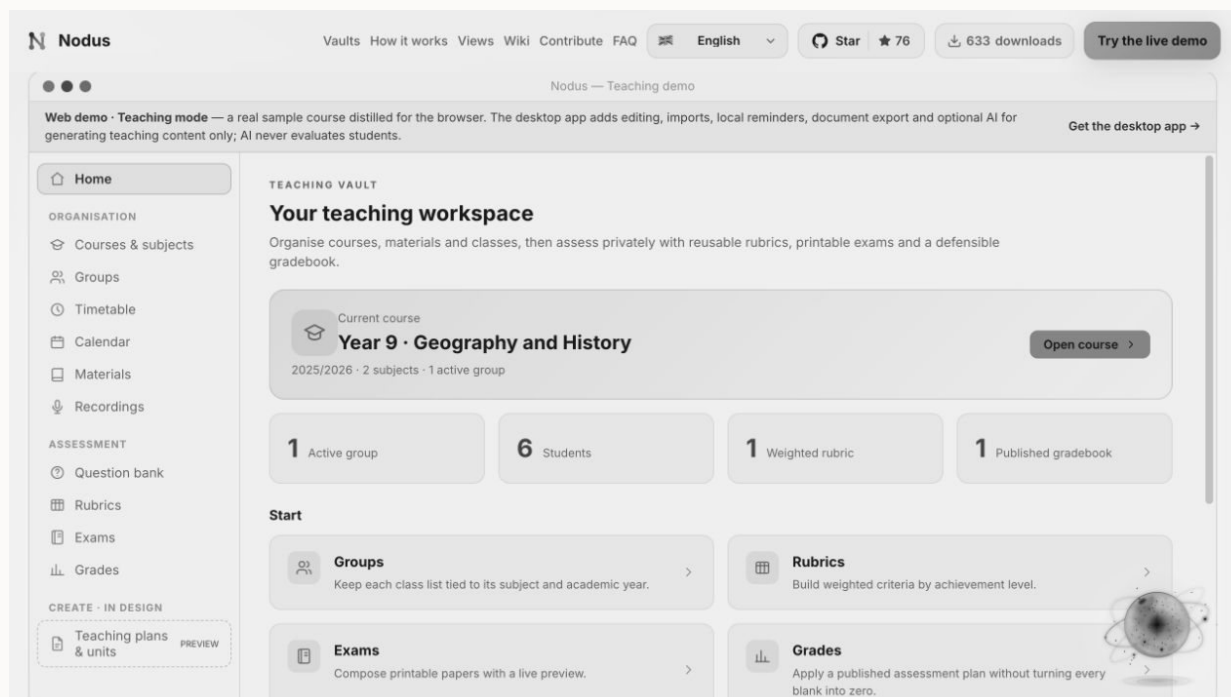
**GOOD PRACTICE**

- Permanent redaction in Protect is local and irreversible in the exported copy.
- Published server spaces should contain only material intended for their readers.

## PART II · VAULT GUIDE

# Complete Teaching workflow

The Teaching vault connects courses, groups, materials and schedules to reusable questions, rubrics, exams and defensible gradebooks. AI may help create teaching content but never evaluates students.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## ORIENTATION

### 1 Home and academic-year overview

Resume the current course and monitor groups, rubrics, exams and gradebooks.

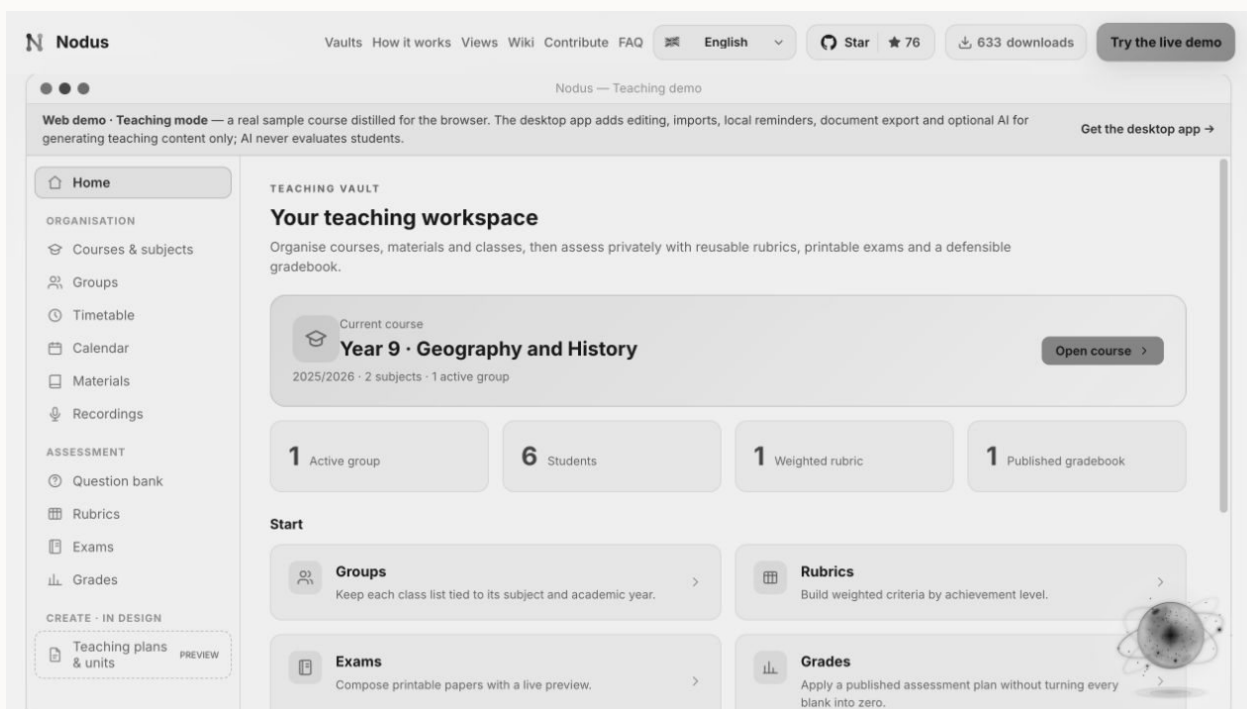
Home provides shortcuts and recent activity while keeping assessment objects attached to their subject and academic year.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Confirm the active academic year and course.
2. Review group, rubric, exam and gradebook totals.
3. Open the most relevant recent item or start destination.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Archive completed years rather than reusing their assessment objects silently.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## ORGANISATION

# 2 Courses and subjects

Define the academic-year structure that materials and assessment will reference.

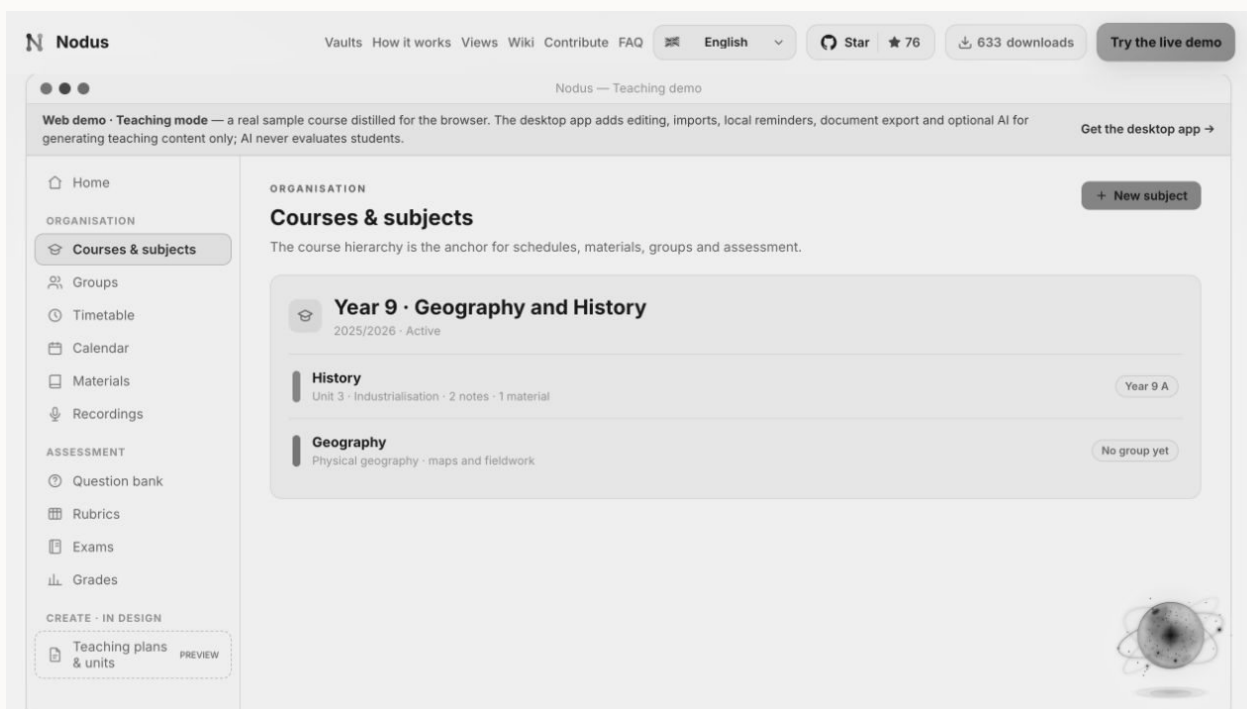
Subjects carry consistent names, colours and schedules. A course is the organisational parent for planning and reporting.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Create the academic year and course.
2. Add subjects with clear codes, names, colours and teaching load.
3. Review that groups, materials and assessment objects point to the correct subject.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Keep historical subjects unchanged after grades are published.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## ORGANISATION

### 3 Groups and private rosters

Keep class lists attached to the right subject and year.

Roster data remains local and is excluded from AI workflows. Group views support organisation, not automated profiling.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Create a group and choose its subject and academic year.
2. Add students manually or import the approved roster format.
3. Review identifiers and duplicates, then restrict exports to the minimum necessary data.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Never paste names, grades or student answers into an AI prompt.

## ORGANISATION

### 4 Timetable

Arrange recurring teaching slots with subject identity and location.

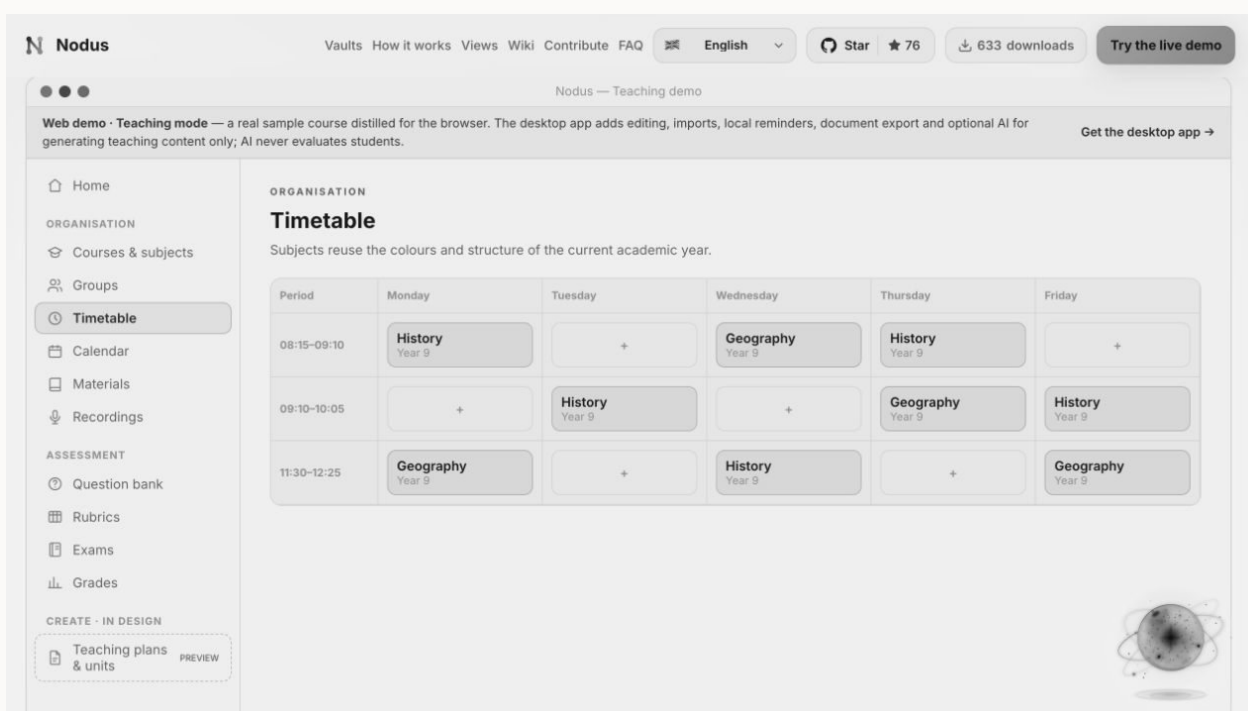
Timetable represents the weekly pattern; Calendar carries individual dates, deadlines and exceptions.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Choose the active year and week layout.
2. Add class blocks with subject, group, time and room.
3. Check collisions and add one-off changes to Calendar.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Record the time zone for remote or cross-campus teaching.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

#### ORGANISATION

## 5 Calendar

Plan sessions, deadlines, exams and reminders.

Dated events can link back to courses, subjects and assessment objects, keeping preparation and delivery together.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Create an event with type, date and related subject.
2. Add a local reminder and a link to the relevant material or exam.

3. Review month and agenda views for workload conflicts.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Add moderation and feedback deadlines, not only student-facing dates.

## ORGANISATION

# 6 Teaching materials

Organise source files and classroom resources by subject and unit.

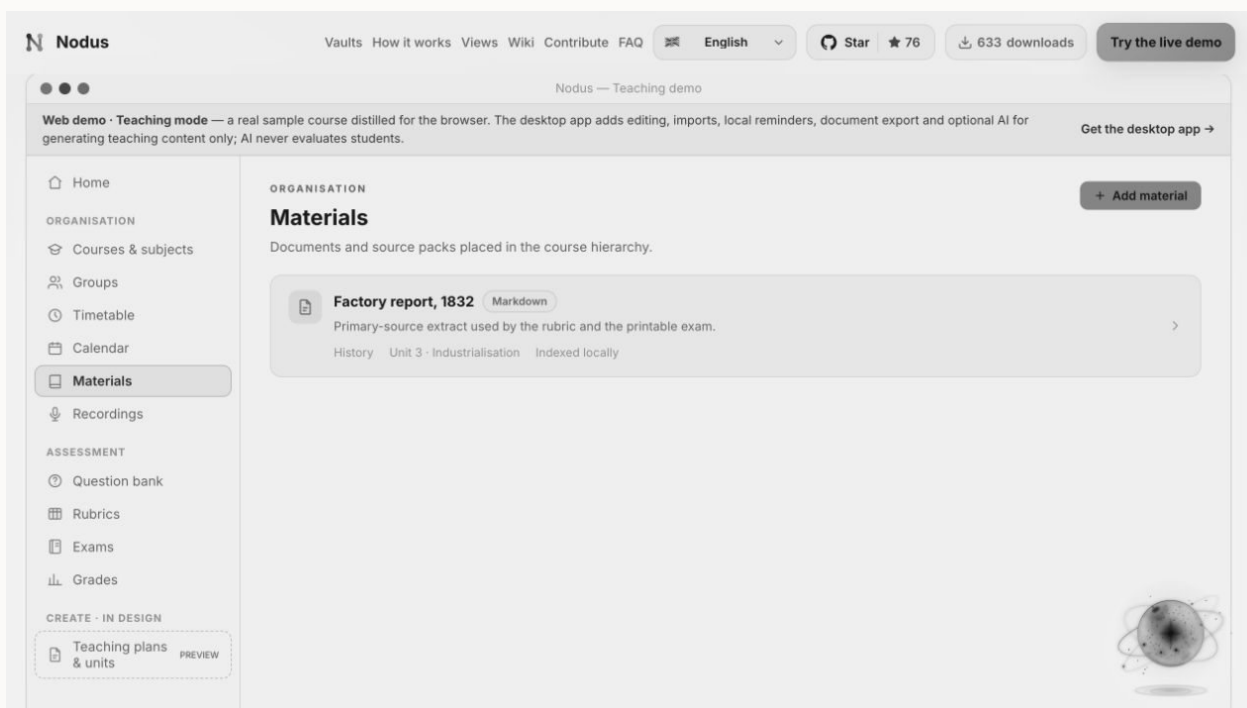
Materials can support question or rubric drafting, but generated content must be reviewed by the teacher.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Import or create a material and assign subject, topic and audience.
2. Review extraction and preserve the original file.
3. Link the material to sessions or use a selected scope when drafting questions.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Check licensing before distributing third-party material.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## ORGANISATION

# 7 Recordings

Keep permitted class recordings and transcripts attached to the course.

Local transcription reduces unnecessary disclosure. Recording and retention must follow institutional policy and participant consent.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Confirm consent and choose the correct subject before recording or import.
2. Transcribe locally and review errors.
3. Link useful segments to teaching notes or materials, then apply the retention policy.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- A pedagogical use case does not override recording consent.

## ASSESSMENT

# 8 Question bank

Create reusable questions by subject, topic, type and difficulty.

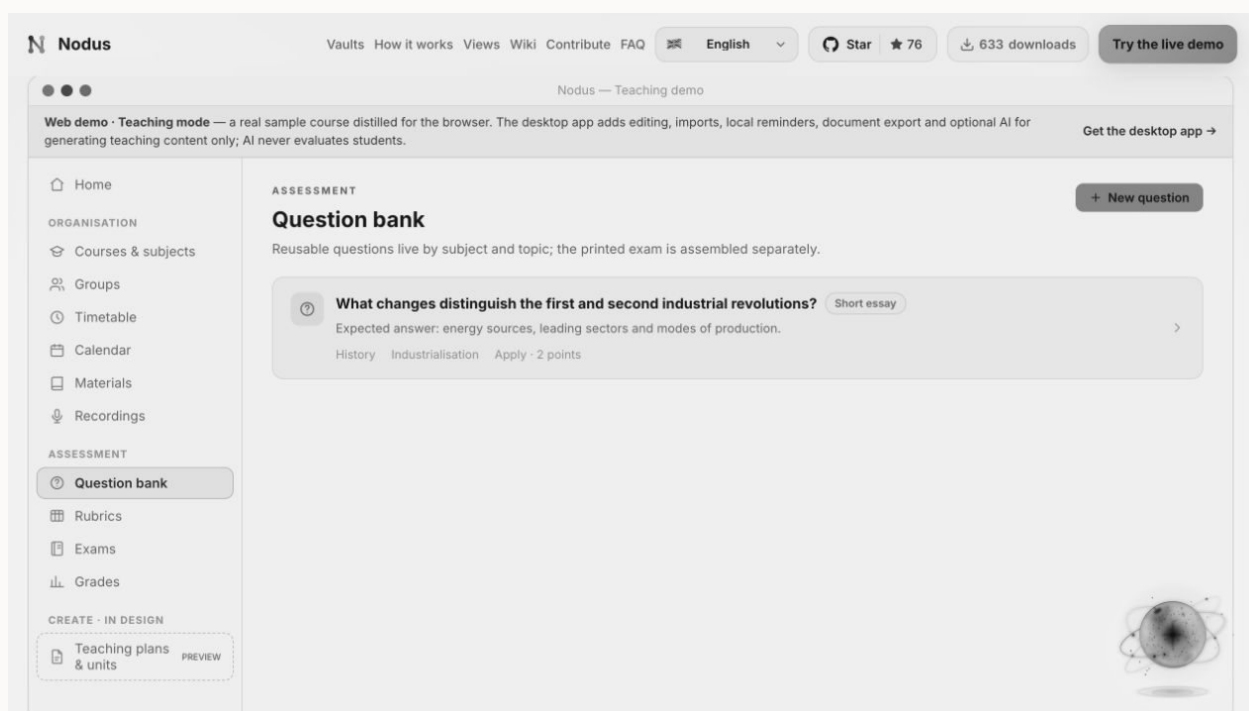
Questions can be drafted manually or from selected teaching material. AI output remains unapproved content and is never used to evaluate a student.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Create a question or generate a draft from an explicit material scope.
2. Review wording, expected answer, marking guidance, difficulty and accessibility.
3. Approve and tag the question before adding it to an exam.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Maintain parallel items and review for cultural or linguistic bias.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## ASSESSMENT

# 9 Rubrics

Define weighted criteria and achievement levels before marking.

A rubric separates criteria, performance descriptors and weights. Publishing or locking a version protects the assessment basis from silent changes.

### STEP BY STEP

1. Create a rubric for a subject and assessment task.
2. Add distinct criteria, weights and observable descriptors at each level.
3. Validate the total, pilot on sample work and publish the approved version.

### GOOD PRACTICE

- Describe observable performance, not personality or presumed effort.

## ASSESSMENT

# 10 Exam builder and print export

Compose an exam from approved questions with a live printable preview.

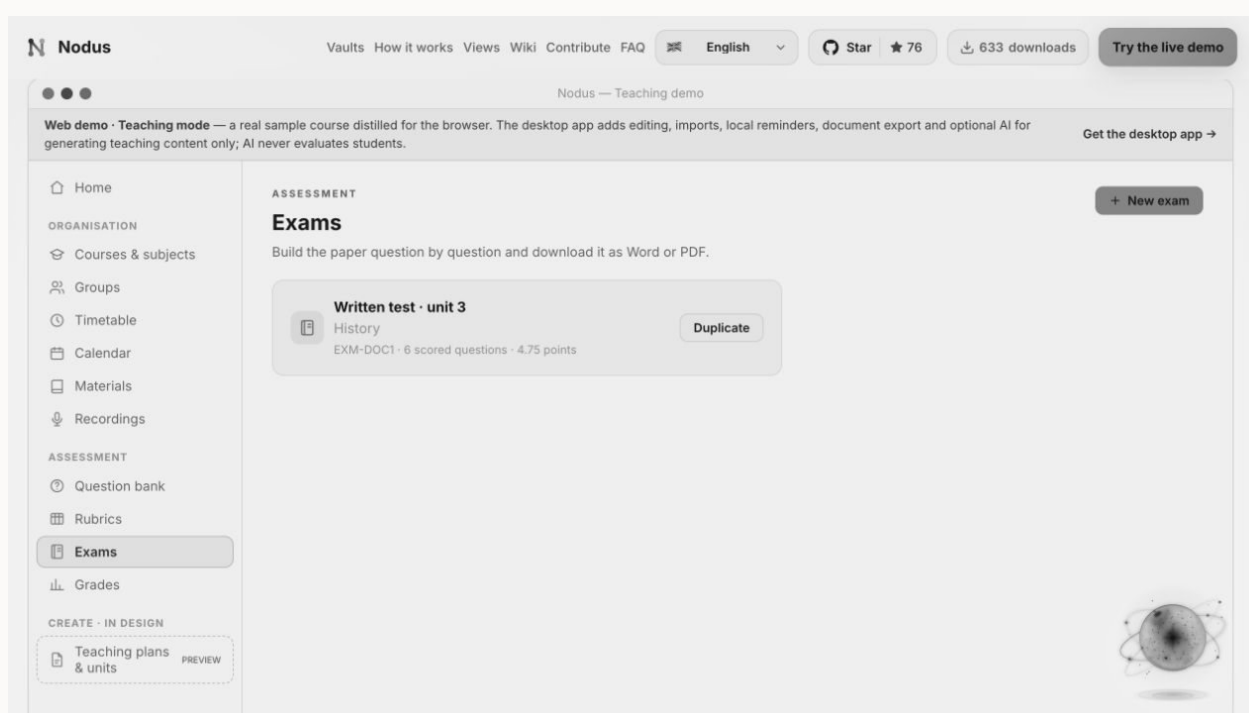
The builder manages sections, points, instructions and answer keys. Export creates a professional paper while the teacher controls the final content.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Create an exam with subject, duration, instructions and total points.
2. Add approved questions, organise sections and inspect pagination in the preview.
3. Generate the student paper and solution copy, then proofread both before printing.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Check that points, time and cognitive demand align with the published plan.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

#### ASSESSMENT

## 11 Gradebooks and assessment plans

Apply transparent weighting rules without turning every blank into zero.

A gradebook derives its rules from a published assessment plan and distinguishes missing, excused and not-yet-entered values. AI never grades or profiles students.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Create or select the approved assessment plan and verify weights.

2. Create the gradebook for the correct group and enter or import marks.
3. Review missing-value semantics, calculations and outliers before publishing or exporting.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Keep an audit trail for manual overrides and moderation decisions.

## CREATE

# 12 Teaching plans and units

Preview the developing space for outcomes, units and aligned activities.

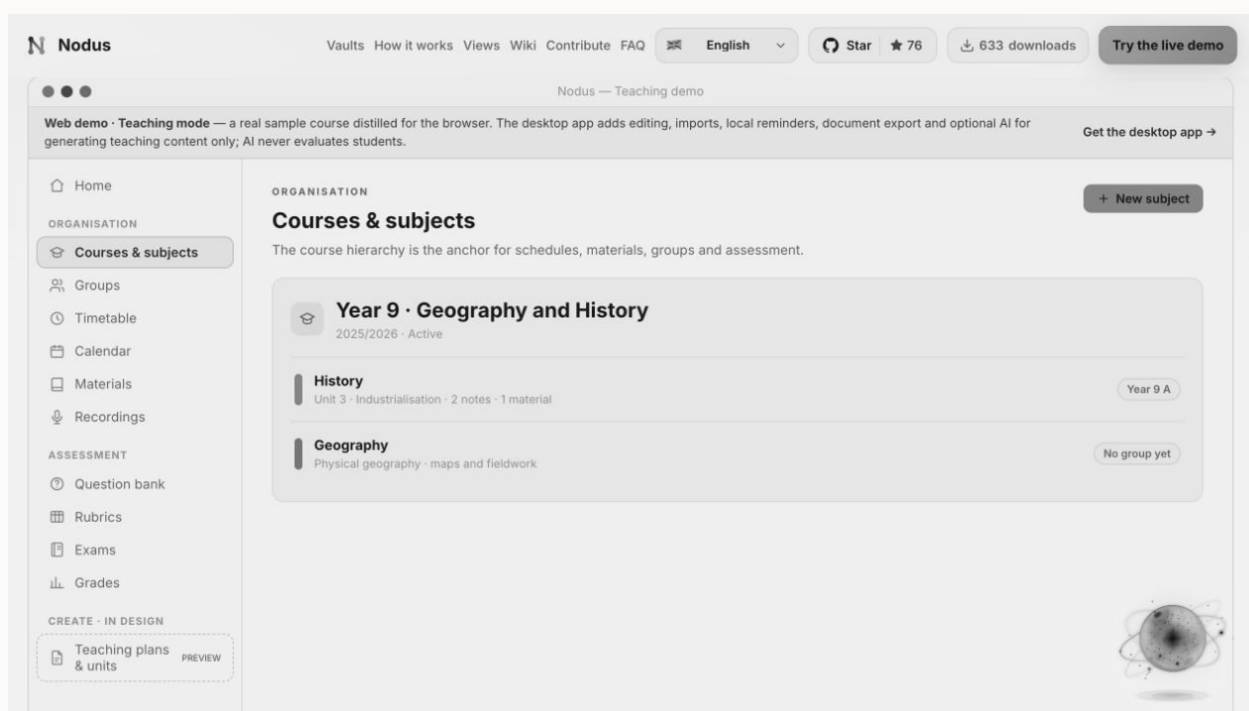
Teaching plans and units are marked as in design. Use them for exploration, not as the only authoritative copy of a required institutional plan.

#### STEP BY STEP

1. Open the preview and review its current capability notice.
2. Sketch outcomes, units and links to materials or assessment.
3. Export or duplicate critical planning information in the required institutional system.

#### GOOD PRACTICE

- Treat preview features as changeable until they are declared stable.



English interface shown with the built-in sample vault.

## CONFIGURE

## 13 Privacy and responsible AI

Use AI for teaching content only; keep rosters, marks and student answers out of models.

Nodus enforces a domain boundary around student data. Deterministic calculations and professional judgement remain local; optional models may draft non-personal teaching material.

## STEP BY STEP

1. Configure providers and review the teaching AI policy.
2. Use only anonymised, non-student material for optional generation.
3. Verify backups, access controls and exports before handling a live roster.

## GOOD PRACTICE

- If a task evaluates, predicts or profiles a student, do not send it to AI.

## REFERENCE

# Completion checklist

- The vault scope and name match the project.
- Sources or records have preserved originals and reviewed metadata.
- Generated interpretations have been checked against their evidence.
- Optional providers and integrations use only the intended data.
- Exports have been proofread in their final format.
- A recent backup has been created and verified.

This manual documents the stable English workflow represented in Nodus 4.1. Interface details may evolve between releases; the in-app privacy notice and release notes govern the exact behaviour of the installed version.